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Rose

December 1942

"*Aufstehen, funf*," the guard called out from the hallway.

Rose was sitting on the velvety red seat in the cinema in Orléans, her fingers intertwined with André's. The gentle caress of his thumb on her hand filled her with contentment and warmth. She longed for the dreamlike moment to continue and kept her eyes closed to prevent his hand from slipping out of hers.

"Wake up," Léa said. "It's five o'clock. The others are already moving." She felt Léa poke her shoulder. "It's the first day of December, too!"

Rose opened her eyes. It was still dark outside—surely not morning. She pulled the gray blanket over her head and turned to the wall.

"Our shift starts at six. We must wash, dress and eat." Léa yanked the blanket off her, and the icy air hit Rose. "Remember what Lagerführer Klein said: being late means the Meister will dock half our salary for the day."

The mention of the Lagerführer's name made Rose sit up. She'd never seen such brutality in a woman: willing to strike another over something as minor as the position of the patch on her apron.

Rose climbed down the ladder—Léa had the lower bunk—and her bare feet touched the freezing concrete floor. She quickly slid into the wooden shoes that were part of their uniform, feeling their discomfort as she clattered along the hall. They were too big, nearly impossible to keep on. The Lagerführer said they only came in one size. Rose found she could keep them on by gliding forward like a skater, sliding one foot after the other. Stairs were impossible. At least the sisters, arriving in Glashütte in